

From: [Wynne, Marc A.](#)
To: [Wynne, Marc A.](#)
Subject: FW: RFI from HVAC Min re: VA psychedelic research funding
Date: Tuesday, January 16, 2024 11:51:09 AM

From: Tenhula, Wendy <Wendy.Tenhula@va.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, January 10, 2024 8:21 PM
To: Smyth, Miriam <Miriam.Smyth@va.gov>
Cc: VHA 14RD Action <vha14rdaction@va.gov>; Wynne, Marc A. <Marc.Wynne@va.gov>; Verna, Matthew <Matthew.Verna@va.gov>; Verwiell, John M. <John.Verwiell@va.gov>; Langston, Joy A. <Joy.Langston@va.gov>; Clark, Sara <sara.clark@va.gov>; McClair, Vetisha <Vetisha.McClair@va.gov>; Bever, Christopher T. (he/him/his) <Christopher.Bever@va.gov>; Berlow, Jason <Jason.Berlow@va.gov>
Subject: Re: RFI from HVAC Min re: VA psychedelic research funding

My recollection is that the \$2 million figure provided by Rachel to the USH was a floor, not a ceiling. If you or others remember it differently I can check with Rachel tomorrow.
Thanks for looking at this and raising the concern.

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From: Smyth, Miriam <Miriam.Smyth@va.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, January 10, 2024 6:21 PM
To: Tenhula, Wendy <Wendy.Tenhula@va.gov>
Cc: VHA 14RD Action <vha14rdaction@va.gov>; Wynne, Marc A. <Marc.Wynne@va.gov>; Verna, Matthew <Matthew.Verna@va.gov>; Verwiell, John M. <John.Verwiell@va.gov>; Langston, Joy A. <Joy.Langston@va.gov>; Clark, Sara <sara.clark@va.gov>; McClair, Vetisha <Vetisha.McClair@va.gov>; Bever, Christopher T. (he/him/his) <Christopher.Bever@va.gov>; Berlow, Jason <Jason.Berlow@va.gov>
Subject: RE: RFI from HVAC Min re: VA psychedelic research funding

Wendy:

Many thanks for writing this. It looks good to me.

The only niggling concern is whether mention of the "\$2M" ceiling in psychedelic funding is likely to surface anywhere. My recollection is that Rachel gave that number to Dr. Elnahal when he was en route to a WH meeting. But, I am happy to put that concern aside .

From: Berlow, Jason <Jason.Berlow@va.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, January 10, 2024 4:21 PM
To: Tenhula, Wendy <Wendy.Tenhula@va.gov>; Bever, Christopher T. (he/him/his) <Christopher.Bever@va.gov>; Smyth, Miriam <Miriam.Smyth@va.gov>; McClair, Vetisha <Vetisha.McClair@va.gov>
Cc: VHA 14RD Action <vha14rdaction@va.gov>; Wynne, Marc A. <Marc.Wynne@va.gov>; Verna, Matthew <Matthew.Verna@va.gov>; Verwiell, John M. <John.Verwiell@va.gov>; Langston, Joy A.

<Joy.Langston@va.gov>; Clark, Sara <sara.clark@va.gov>

Subject: RE: RFI from HVAC Min re: VA psychedelic research funding

I concur . I think this is in within the mental health DRA.

From: Tenhula, Wendy <Wendy.Tenhula@va.gov>

Sent: Wednesday, January 10, 2024 3:57 PM

To: Bever, Christopher T. (he/him/his) <Christopher.Bever@va.gov>; Smyth, Miriam <Miriam.Smyth@va.gov>; Mcclair, Vetisha <Vetisha.McClair@va.gov>

Cc: VHA 14RD Action <vha14rdaction@va.gov>; Wynne, Marc A. <Marc.Wynne@va.gov>; Verna, Matthew <Matthew.Verna@va.gov>; Verwiel, John M. <John.Verwiel@va.gov>; Berlow, Jason <Jason.Berlow@va.gov>

Subject: Re: RFI from HVAC Min re: VA psychedelic research funding

Good afternoon,

Since I know Miriam and Vetisha are slammed this week, I took the liberty of drafting a response to this request. I'm also adding our finance team to give them a chance to provide input since this is a question about money. **Since this is due on Thursday morning, if I don't hear anything by 10:00AM, I will assume it's OK to submit.**

Thanks,
Wendy

REQUEST: I imagine the overall amount of funding VA plans to direct to psychedelic research will depend on the quantity and quality of the research proposals submitted, but has VHA set a ceiling for the amount of research funds that could potentially be directed to these studies for FY24 or beyond?

RESPONSE: VHA has not set a ceiling for the amount of research funds that could potentially be directed to studies of psychedelic assisted treatment for mental health conditions. The amount of funding that will go toward this work will depend on the quality of the research proposals that are submitted to the Office of Research and Development by VA researchers, the results of the VA's rigorous scientific peer review process and the availability of funding through the Medical Research and Prosthetics appropriation.